

**Sultanate of Oman**  
**Nama Water Services Company SAOC**

**Consultancy Services for Design and Supervision for STP, Sewer and TE Networks  
Systems in Ibri**

Tender No. T/2719110/2025

# **Concept Design Report**

**Revision 0**

**Renardet S.A. & Partners Consulting Engineers**

Project 2621 · August 2026

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## Abbreviations and definitions

| Term         | Meaning                                                         |
|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| AAF          | Average annual flow                                             |
| APSR         | Authority for Public Services Regulation                        |
| BOD          | Biochemical oxygen demand                                       |
| CAPEX / OPEX | Capital expenditure / operating expenditure                     |
| CESMM3       | Civil Engineering Standard Method of Measurement, third edition |
| COD          | Chemical oxygen demand                                          |
| EIA          | Environmental impact assessment                                 |
| GIS          | Geographic information system                                   |
| LPCD         | Litres per capita per day                                       |
| MoHUP        | Ministry of Housing and Urban Planning                          |
| NCSI         | National Centre for Statistics and Information                  |
| NOC          | No objection certificate                                        |
| PAEW         | Public Authority for Electricity and Water                      |
| PE           | Population equivalent                                           |
| Qadf         | Average daily flow                                              |
| Qpdf         | Peak daily flow                                                 |
| SRT          | Solids retention time                                           |
| STP          | Sewage treatment plant                                          |
| TKN          | Total Kjeldahl nitrogen                                         |
| TSS          | Total suspended solids                                          |
| UTM 40N      | Universal Transverse Mercator zone 40 North, WGS 84 datum       |

### A note on the term TE

The Terms of Reference and this report use TE to mean treated effluent, that is the treated product of the sewage treatment plant. The NAMA design guidelines define TE as trade effluent and use TSE for treated sewage effluent. To avoid ambiguity, this report uses the term treated effluent in full, and TSE where a guideline value is quoted.<sup>1</sup>

<sup>1</sup> PAM-GUD-201, Table 1, page 16; PAM-GUD-203, page 13. Confirmation of the preferred convention is requested.

## Executive summary

This report presents the concept design for the wastewater and treated effluent systems serving Ibri, together with the sewage treatment plant that will receive the collected flow. It records the data collected to date, the checks applied to that data, the design basis adopted, and the state of the work at the date of issue.

## The project area

The study area covers 531.4 square kilometres within the Wilayat of Ibri, Governorate of Adh Dhahirah, and contains twenty-five named settlements. All spatial work is carried out in UTM zone 40 North on the WGS 84 datum.<sup>2</sup>

## Data collected

Data has been obtained from Nama Water Services covering the existing wastewater assets, the potable water network, electricity accounts and the cadastral plot layer. The datasets have been loaded into the project geographic information system, checked against the project boundary, and assessed for completeness. Section 7 records the outcome of those checks in full.

Four points arise from that assessment and are carried through the report.

- **Existing assets** — 310.9 kilometres of gravity sewer, 33.2 kilometres of force main and 45.7 kilometres of treated effluent main lie within the study area.
- **Potable water** — the PAEW dataset provides 647.8 kilometres of water mains within the study area, and is adopted as the source for utility interfaces.
- **Electricity accounts** — 33,970 accounts have been used to establish the number of properties on each plot and the category of use.
- **Survey** — a topographic and utility survey covering the whole study area is in progress and will confirm levels, diameters and asset condition.

## Design basis

Wastewater generation is derived from water demand in accordance with the NAMA design guidelines. For the Governorate of Adh Dhahirah the domestic consumption rate is 164 litres per capita per day, with uplifts of 22 per cent for non-domestic and 14 per cent for governmental consumption. Return rates of 85 per cent for domestic and tanker supply and 54 per cent for non-domestic supply are applied to obtain the wastewater flow.<sup>3</sup>

An occupancy rate of 5.32 persons per domestic property has been derived from the settlement populations and the counted domestic electricity accounts. Section 15 sets out the derivation and the checks applied to it.<sup>4</sup>

## State of the work

The design basis, the data assessment and the assessment framework are complete. The network design has been developed and tested over a representative area of the town and is being extended to the whole study

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<sup>2</sup> Area measured from the project boundary supplied with the Inception Report. Two boundary versions were issued with that report; confirmation of the approved boundary is requested, and the item is listed in Section 5.

<sup>3</sup> PAM-GUD-201, Table 11, page 60 and Table 19, page 71. The guideline states that the consumption values apply in the absence of updated figures and should be validated by NAMA before design.

<sup>4</sup> The guideline derives occupancy from population and housing units published by NCSI. Housing units are not published at settlement level, and counted domestic accounts have been used in their place. The departure is recorded in Section 10.

area as the survey data becomes available. The options for the sewer network, the treated effluent network and the treatment plant are presented as a framework in Part F and will be completed in the next revision.

### Matters requiring confirmation

Six matters require confirmation from Nama Water Services. They are set out in Section 5 with the relevant references, and are summarised here.

|   | Matter                                            |
|---|---------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | The design horizon to be adopted                  |
| 2 | The approved project boundary                     |
| 3 | Georeferenced versions of the project figures     |
| 4 | The hydraulic modelling software to be used       |
| 5 | The timing of the environmental impact assessment |
| 6 | The convention for the term TE                    |





## **Part A Project, scope and process**

### **1 Introduction and background**

Nama Water Services is developing wastewater collection, treated effluent distribution and sewage treatment for the Wilayat of Ibri. Renardet S.A. & Partners has been appointed to provide consultancy services for the design and supervision of these works.

This report is the concept design deliverable. It establishes the design basis, records and assesses the data collected, and sets out the framework within which options for the sewer network, the treated effluent network and the treatment plant are developed.

#### **1.1 Objectives**

The Terms of Reference set three objectives for the work: to verify the Regional Master Plan, to establish the ultimate expected sewage flow in the Ibri catchment, and to develop the concept, preliminary and detailed designs together with the tender documentation.

#### **1.2 Structure of this report**

The report follows the structure approved for the concept stage. Part A records the project and its process. Part B presents the data and the assessment of it. Part C sets out the design basis. Part D establishes demand and flow. Part E assesses the existing system. Part F presents the options. Part G carries the technical and financial appraisal, and Part H the delivery arrangements.

## 2 Scope and boundaries

### 2.1 The study area

The study area covers 531.4 square kilometres and contains twenty-five named settlements. Ibri is the principal settlement; the remainder are distributed along the wadi system and the main road corridors.<sup>5</sup>

**Figure 1 Project location and study area boundary**

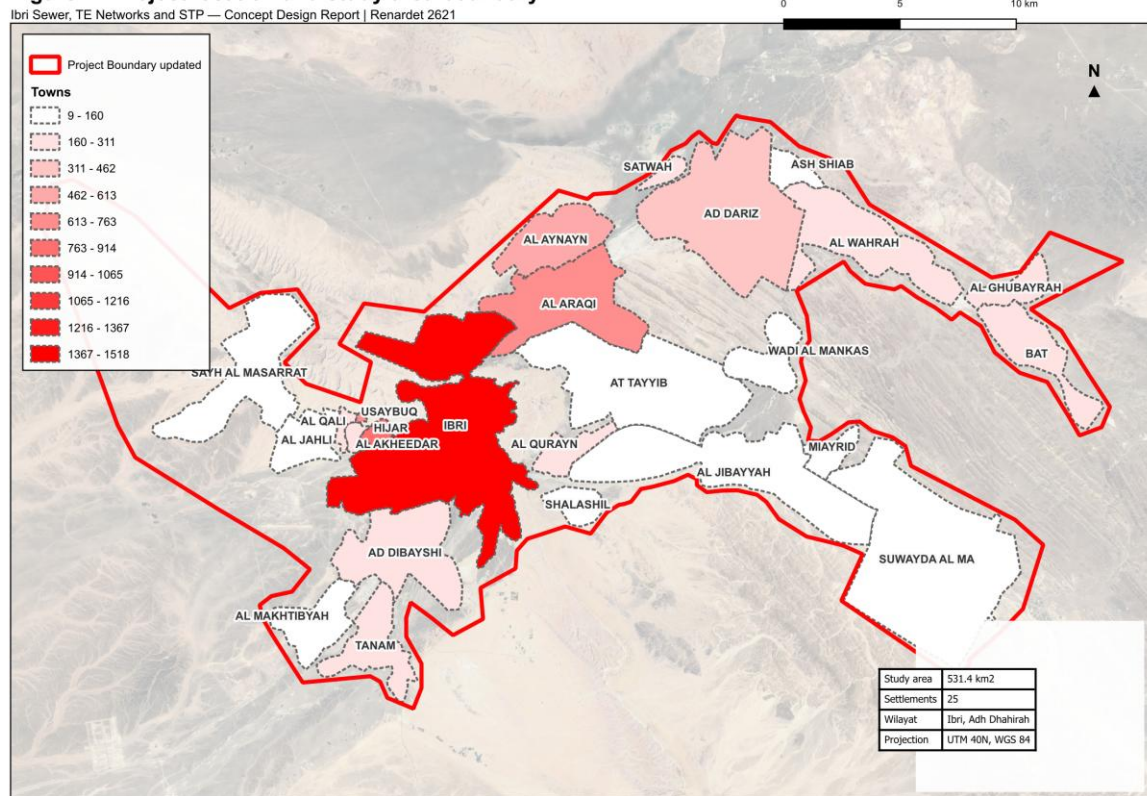


Figure 1 Project location and study area boundary, showing the twenty-five settlements within the Wilayat of Ibri.

### 2.2 Boundary

Two boundary datasets were issued with the Inception Report. The two differ in extent. The larger of the two has been adopted for the work presented here so that no part of the area is omitted, and confirmation of the approved boundary is requested.<sup>6</sup>

### 2.3 Coordinate system

All spatial data is held and all measurements are made in Universal Transverse Mercator zone 40 North on the WGS 84 datum. Datasets supplied in geographic coordinates have been reprojected. Levels are referenced to the terrain model described in Section 8.

<sup>5</sup> Area measured in the project geographic information system from the boundary supplied with the Inception Report, computed in UTM zone 40 North.

<sup>6</sup> Project\_Boundary.kmz and Final\_Boundary\_IBRI.kmz, both supplied in the Inception Report package.

### 3 Programme and design stages

The design comprises four stages: concept design, preliminary design, detailed design and the preparation of tender documents. Each stage is submitted for review and approval before the following stage begins.

The Terms of Reference allow sixty days for the concept design and a further twenty-one days for review. The preliminary design stage begins on approval of the concept design for the treatment plant.<sup>7</sup>

Two programmes have been issued during mobilisation, in the kick-off presentation and in the Inception Report. Confirmation of the governing programme is requested.

### 4 Consultation record

The following meetings have been held with Nama Water Services to the date of this report.

**Table 1 Meetings held**

| Meeting                     | Date         | Outcome                                                       |
|-----------------------------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Kick-off meeting            | 15 July 2026 | Project scope, approach, programme and organisation presented |
| Inception Report submission | August 2026  | Design basis, methodology and programme submitted             |

Coordination with the authorities holding assets in the project area is described in Section 33, together with the register of approvals and no objection certificates.

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<sup>7</sup> Appendix to the Form of Bid, page 147, restated as a contract term at page 177 of the tender document.

## 5 Matters requiring confirmation

The following matters require confirmation from Nama Water Services. Each affects work that would otherwise be carried out twice, and confirmation is therefore requested at the earliest opportunity.

### 5.1 Design horizon

The Terms of Reference define the design horizon as the year of project completion plus twenty-five years, or the ultimate saturated flow. The Inception Report states that the planning and demand assessment extends to the year 2100. The two are different bases and produce different results. Confirmation of the horizon to be adopted is requested.<sup>8</sup>

### 5.2 Project boundary

Two boundary datasets were issued with the Inception Report, differing in extent. Confirmation of the approved boundary is requested, together with the extent to be surveyed.

### 5.3 Project figures

Figures 1, 2 and 3 of the tender define the project location, the areas requiring as-built records, and the areas subject to each design stage. They are supplied as images without coordinates. Georeferenced versions are requested so that the design areas can be established without ambiguity.

### 5.4 Hydraulic modelling software

The Scope of Work requires the wastewater network to be modelled in SewerGEMS and the treated effluent network in WaterGEMS. The staffing schedule in the tender refers to a different package. Confirmation of the software to be used for the deliverable models is requested.<sup>9</sup>

### 5.5 Environmental impact assessment

The design guidelines place environmental impact assessment scoping at the preliminary design stage in one clause and the full assessment at the concept and preliminary stages in another. Confirmation of the scope required at this stage is requested.<sup>10</sup>

### 5.6 Terminology

Confirmation is requested that the term TE, as used in the Terms of Reference and in this report, is understood to mean treated effluent.

### 5.7 Design manual reference

The Terms of Reference require the treatment plant location report to follow item 2.1 of Section 05 of the Wastewater Design Manual. The current revision of PAM-GUD-203 consolidated and renumbered the former manuals, and the corresponding content is now Section 10.1, Site Selection. The report follows Section 10.1, and confirmation is requested.<sup>11</sup>

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<sup>8</sup> Terms of Reference, page 51 of the tender document; Inception Report Revision 0, Section 6.2.

<sup>9</sup> Scope of Work, pages 56, 57, 62, 65 and 73; Bidding Form 24, page 123 of the tender document.

<sup>10</sup> PAM-GUD-201, Table 2, pages 19 to 22, and Section 6.1.4.3, page 44.

<sup>11</sup> PAM-GUD-203 Revision 01, page 2, records the consolidation of the former manuals. Site selection is at pages 63 and 64.

## Part B Data

### 6 Data collection

Data has been requested from Nama Water Services and from the authorities holding assets in the project area. The table below records what has been requested and the position at the date of this report.

**Table 2 Data register**

| Dataset                                      | Received    | Position                                                               |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Existing sewer network, as-built             | Yes         | GIS geometry received. Levels and diameters incomplete; being surveyed |
| Existing force mains                         | Yes         | Received                                                               |
| Existing treated effluent network            | Yes         | Received                                                               |
| Lifting station details                      | Partial     | One station located; equipment and duty details being surveyed         |
| Treatment plant records                      | Partial     | Location and nominal capacity received; operating data outstanding     |
| Electricity account data                     | Yes         | Received                                                               |
| Cadastral plot data                          | Yes         | Received. Land use and missing plots being addressed                   |
| Potable water network                        | Yes         | Received as part of the PAEW dataset                                   |
| Topographic survey                           | In progress | Survey team mobilised                                                  |
| Integrated Master Plan                       | No          | Requested                                                              |
| Plant inflow and tanker records              | No          | Requested                                                              |
| Electricity, telecom and gas service records | No          | To be requested from the respective owners                             |

A topographic and utility survey covering the whole study area is in progress. It will establish cover and invert levels, diameters, materials and condition for the existing sewer, force main and treated effluent networks, together with the lifting stations, the topography and the cadastral boundaries including plot gates. The results will be incorporated in the next revision of this report.

## 7 Assessment of the data

Each dataset has been loaded into the project geographic information system, reprojected where necessary, and checked against the project boundary. This section records the quantity of each dataset, the proportion falling within the study area, and the limitations identified.

### 7.1 Existing wastewater assets

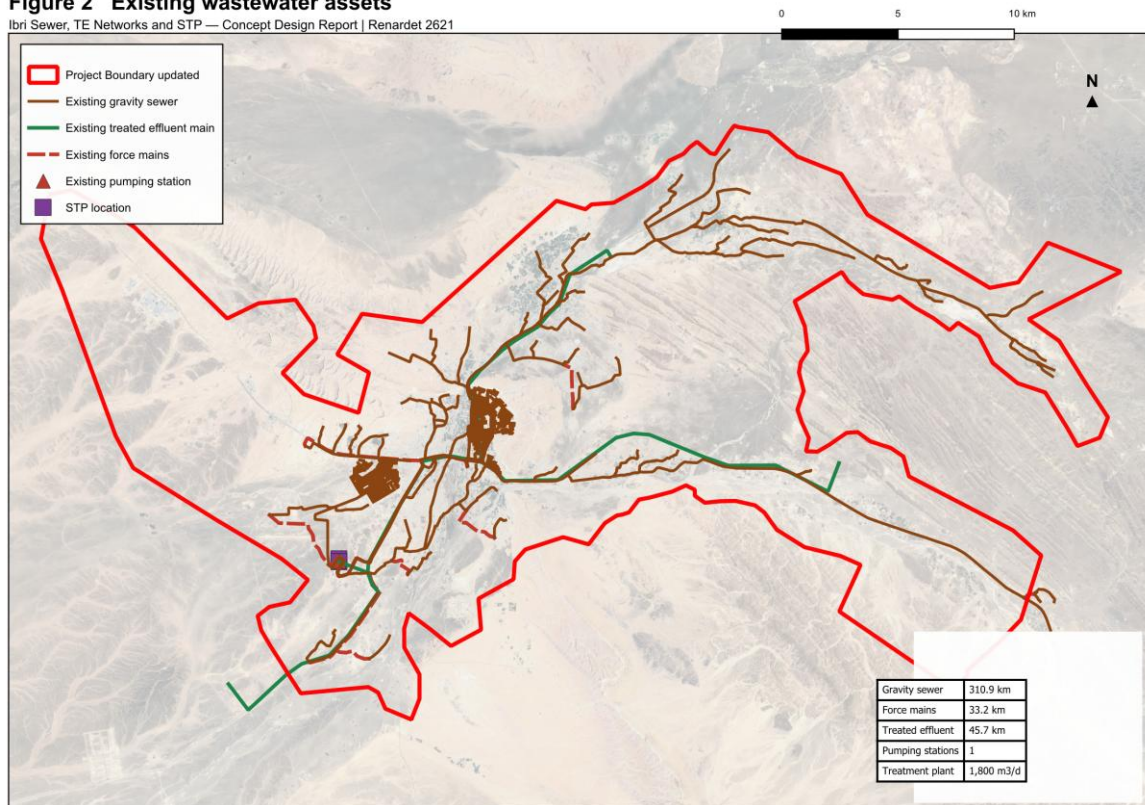
**Table 3 Wastewater assets supplied by Nama Water Services**

| Dataset               | Features | Quantity    | Within the study area | Observation                                                                                     |
|-----------------------|----------|-------------|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Gravity sewer         | 3,396    | 314.3 km    | 310.9 km (99 %)       | diameter recorded on 129 segments carrying 202.7 km; the remaining 111.6 km carries no diameter |
| Force mains           | 9        | 33.6 km     | 33.2 km (99 %)        | diameters 80 to 250 mm                                                                          |
| Treated effluent main | 8        | 49.4 km     | 45.7 km (92 %)        | —                                                                                               |
| Pumping station       | 1        | 1 point     | 1                     | —                                                                                               |
| Treatment plant       | 2        | 2 points    | 2                     | one existing at 1,800 m <sup>3</sup> /d, one shown as design at 29,038 m <sup>3</sup> /d        |
| Plant structures      | 15       | 15 polygons | 15                    | —                                                                                               |

The wastewater datasets are substantially complete in extent, with 99 per cent of the gravity sewer and force main lying within the study area. The principal limitation is attribute completeness: of 314.3 kilometres of gravity sewer, 202.7 kilometres carry a recorded diameter and 111.6 kilometres do not. Levels are not recorded. The survey now in progress will establish both.<sup>12</sup>

**Figure 2 Existing wastewater assets**

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<sup>12</sup> Measured from SEWERLINE\_IBRI.shp as supplied. The tender records that the existing network layout is based on available information; the preparation of complete as-built records and GIS is part of the consultant's scope.



Figure 2 Existing wastewater assets within the study area: gravity sewer, force mains, treated effluent main, pumping station and treatment plant.

## 7.2 Potable water network

Two datasets describing potable water assets were supplied. They differ substantially in coverage.

Table 4 Potable water datasets

| Dataset                  | Features | Quantity     | Within the study area | Observation                                                                        |
|--------------------------|----------|--------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAEW water mains         | 6,156    | 1,315.9 km   | 647.8 km (49 %)       | the usable source for utility interfaces                                           |
| PAEW water laterals      | 1,954    | 12.7 km      | 8.1 km (64 %)         | —                                                                                  |
| PAEW system valves       | 2,866    | 2,866 points | 1,586                 | —                                                                                  |
| PAEW hydrants            | 965      | 965 points   | 568                   | —                                                                                  |
| PAEW services            | 318      | 318 points   | —                     | —                                                                                  |
| PAEW facilities          | 265      | 265 points   | 20                    | —                                                                                  |
| NAMA water mains extract | 90       | 3.5 km       | none                  | located near 55.80 E, 24.27 N, approximately 130 km north-west of the project area |

The PAEW dataset provides 647.8 kilometres of water mains within the study area and is adopted as the source for utility interfaces. The second dataset, supplied under an Ibri file name, contains 3.5 kilometres of mains located approximately 130 kilometres north-west of the project area; none of it falls within the study area. Confirmation is requested that the PAEW dataset is the current record for Ibri.<sup>13</sup>

Figure 3 Potable water network within the study area

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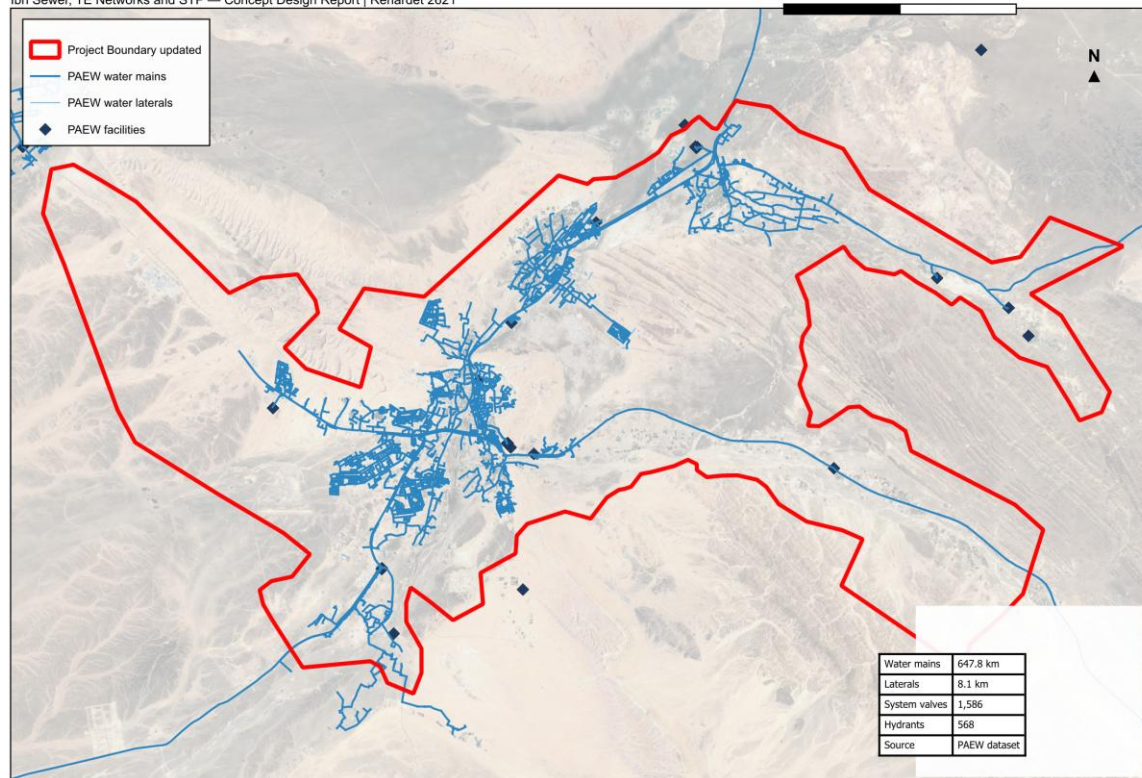


Figure 3 Potable water network within the study area, from the PAEW dataset.

<sup>13</sup> The extent of the second dataset is 55.802 to 55.814 degrees east and 24.269 to 24.292 degrees north, in the vicinity of Al Buraymi.



### 7.3 Electricity accounts

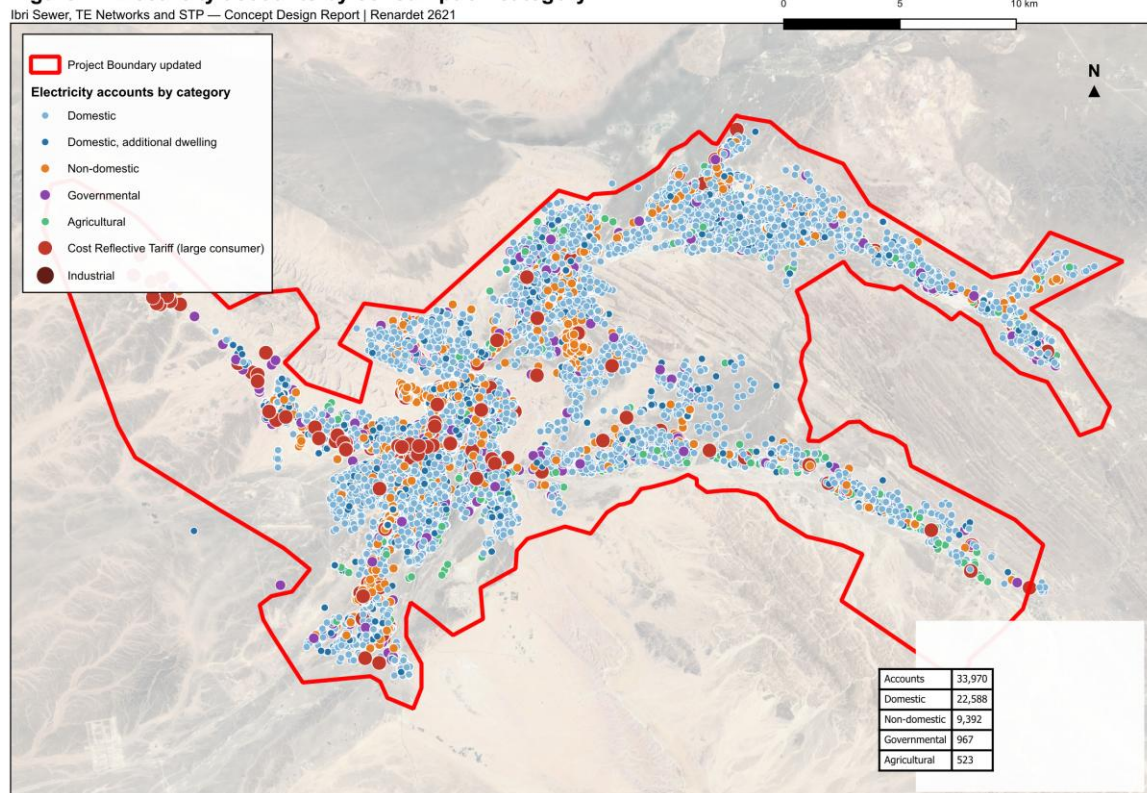
The electricity account dataset contains 33,970 records. Each record carries a tariff name and a coordinate. The dataset does not record land use, floor area or consumption, and the wilayat field is empty on every record. It therefore establishes the number and category of connections at a location, and is used for that purpose in Section 14.<sup>14</sup>

**Table 5 Electricity accounts by tariff**

| Tariff                                  | Accounts      | Category adopted                         |
|-----------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------|
| Primary Account                         | 10,972        | Domestic                                 |
| Primary Account with National Subsidy   | 5,272         | Domestic                                 |
| Additional Account                      | 6,344         | Domestic, additional dwelling            |
| Commercial                              | 9,385         | Non-domestic                             |
| Government                              | 966           | Governmental                             |
| Agricultural                            | 523           | Agricultural                             |
| Cost Reflective Tariff                  | 499           | Large consumer, category to be confirmed |
| Fisheries, Tourism, Industrial, Defence | 9             | Non-domestic and governmental            |
| <b>Total</b>                            | <b>33,970</b> |                                          |

The Cost Reflective Tariff is applied to consumers above a consumption threshold and is therefore a measure of size rather than of use. The 499 accounts carrying it are being resolved against the plot layer and by inspection.<sup>15</sup>

**Figure 4 Electricity accounts by consumption category**



<sup>14</sup> Fields present: identifier, tariff, coordinates in projected and geographic form, governorate and wilayat. The governorate is recorded as Dahira on all records; the wilayat field is empty on all records.

<sup>15</sup> The tariff comprises three variants in the dataset: fixed rate (9 accounts), seasonal (298) and time of use (192).

Figure 4 Electricity accounts by consumption category. The pattern of connections defines the developed extent of each settlement.

## 7.4 Cadastral and settlement data

The cadastral plot layer supplied by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Planning provides plot geometry. It does not distinguish developed from undeveloped plots, does not record land use, and does not record the number of dwellings on a plot. Plots present on the ground are absent from the layer in places. A corrected layer is in preparation and the survey now in progress will establish the cadastral boundaries including plot gates.

Figure 5 Settlements and cadastral plots

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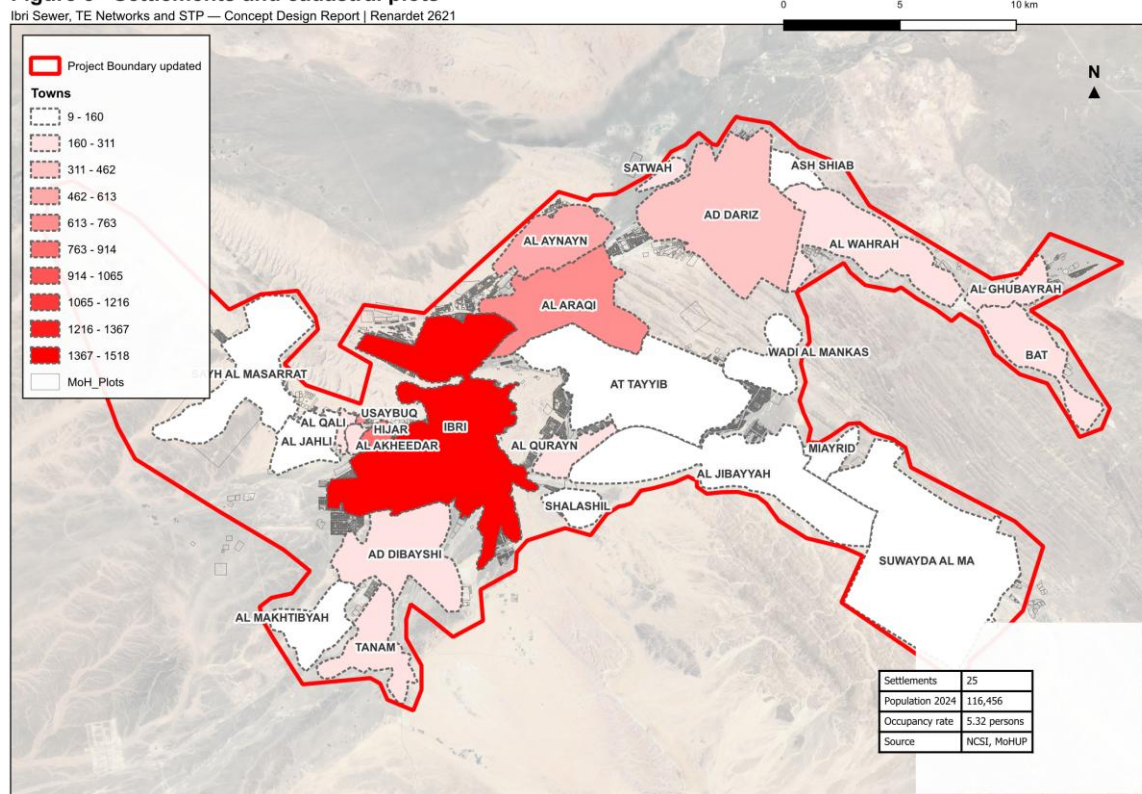


Figure 5 Settlements and cadastral plots within the study area.

## 7.5 Other datasets supplied

Table 6 Further datasets received

| Dataset                   | Extent            | Observation                                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Electricity accounts      | 33,970 points     | Tariff, coordinates and governorate. No land use, floor area or consumption is recorded.                                                                                           |
| Ibri Bypass scheme        | 13,404 placemarks | A drawing export carrying 11,715 sublayers of blocks, hatches and dimensions. Suitable as a positional reference; conversion is required before it can be used as structured data. |
| Al Raybah pipelines       | 3 files           | Pipeline alignments at 110, 180 and 225 mm, within the project area.                                                                                                               |
| Rehabilitation packages   | 6 archives        | Work-order submissions covering Al Sad, Khadiil, Yanqul, Dhank and Hay Al Aqabah, comprising drawings, meter schedules and geodatabases.                                           |
| House connection packages | 4 archives        | Contractor submissions dated May and June 2026.                                                                                                                                    |

Five of the datasets supplied relate to areas outside the project boundary and have not been used. They are recorded here for completeness.

**Table 7 Datasets relating to areas outside the project**

| Dataset         | Extent         | Location                                      |
|-----------------|----------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Mudhaibi zone 6 | 544 placemarks | Wilayat of Mudhaibi, Ash Sharqiyah            |
| Mudhaibi zone 8 | 461 placemarks | Wilayat of Mudhaibi, Ash Sharqiyah            |
| Qabil Al Rukha  | 5 placemarks   | Wilayat of Mudhaibi                           |
| Qunaib          | 4 placemarks   | Wilayat of Mudhaibi                           |
| New location    | 8 placemarks   | Approximately 30 km north of the project area |

## 8 Survey and investigation

### 8.1 Topographic and utility survey

A survey team is mobilised and working across the study area. The survey covers the existing sewer network, lifting stations, force mains and treated effluent network as built; the topography; and the cadastral boundaries including plot gates. Its outputs will establish the levels, diameters and condition that the supplied datasets do not carry, and will be incorporated in the next revision of this report.

### 8.2 Terrain model

A bare-earth terrain model at 0.5 metre resolution covering the study area is in use for the work presented here. It will be superseded by the topographic survey for design purposes.<sup>16</sup>

### 8.3 Geotechnical investigation and trial pits

Geotechnical investigation and trial pits form part of the scope. Fifty trial pits are to be carried out at critical locations proposed by the consultant and approved by Nama Water Services. The programme of pits will be set out following the desk study of utility records described in Section 33.

## 9 Existing systems: as-built records and GIS

The preparation of as-built records and geographic information for the existing sewer and treated effluent systems forms part of the scope of work. The datasets supplied provide the geometry of those systems; the survey in progress will establish the levels, diameters, materials and condition required to complete the records.

The records will be prepared to the Nama Water Services specification and uploaded to the client's geographic information system for acceptance. Progress will be reported in the next revision.

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<sup>16</sup> The model excludes buildings and is held in UTM zone 40 North.

## Part C Basis of design

### 10 Codes, standards and departures

The design follows the Nama Water Services design guidelines and standard specifications. Where a value is taken from a guideline it is cited to the guideline and page.

Table 8 Governing documents

| Reference   | Title                                                     |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| PAM-GUD-201 | General Design Guidelines, Revision 01, March 2026        |
| PAM-GUD-202 | Water and TSE Design Guidelines, Revision 01, March 2026  |
| PAM-GUD-203 | Wastewater Design Guidelines, Revision 01, March 2026     |
| MD 145/1993 | Ministerial Decision, treated effluent and sludge reuse   |
| MD 159/2005 | Ministerial Decision, discharge to the marine environment |
| MD 41/2017  | Ministerial Decision, ambient air quality                 |

#### 10.1 Departures

Three departures from the guidelines arise from the data available. Each is set out below with the reason and the consequence, and confirmation is requested.

Table 9 Departures from the design guidelines

| Subject                              | Guideline position                                                                                 | Position adopted                                            | Reason                                                                                                      |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Occupancy rate                       | Population divided by housing units, both from NCSI                                                | Population divided by counted domestic electricity accounts | Housing units are not published at settlement level                                                         |
| Non-domestic and governmental demand | Unit rates per pupil, bed, employee and floor area where detailed land use allocation is available | The published governorate ratios                            | The quantities the unit rates require are not recorded in any dataset held                                  |
| Allocation of non-domestic demand    | Distributed across the served population                                                           | Placed on the plots that generate it                        | A residential street generates no commercial flow; the total is unchanged and only its distribution differs |

The unit rates will be adopted for non-domestic and governmental demand as soon as the quantities they require become available.<sup>17</sup>

### 11 Level of service and resilience

The systems are designed to convey and treat the flows arising across the design horizon without surcharge in the collection network and without loss of treatment capacity at the plant.

- **Redundancy** — sufficient capacity is provided that the design peak flow can be achieved with any one unit out of service.
- **Design margin** — a margin of ten per cent is applied to the treatment plant design flow, over and above redundancy.
- **Flood resilience** — structures are sited and set above the flood levels described in Section 29, and the plant is to remain operational during floods.
- **Failure** — emergency provisions are described in Section 26.

<sup>17</sup> PAM-GUD-201, Table 12, page 61. The rates are expressed per pupil, per bed, per employee and per square metre of floor area.



## 12 Design criteria: collection network

The criteria below govern the gravity network. All are taken from the wastewater design guideline.

**Table 10 Gravity sewer design criteria**

| Criterion                            | Value                                    | Reference               |
|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Self-cleansing velocity              | not less than 0.75 m/s at peak flow      | PAM-GUD-203 p26         |
| Preferred velocity                   | 0.90 m/s at peak flow                    | PAM-GUD-203 p26         |
| Maximum velocity                     | 3.0 m/s at the design depth of flow      | PAM-GUD-203 p27         |
| Depth of flow, up to 350 mm          | 0.65 of the diameter at peak flow        | PAM-GUD-203 Table 10    |
| Depth of flow, above 350 mm          | 0.50 of the diameter at peak flow        | PAM-GUD-203 Table 10    |
| Roughness, Colebrook-White           | 1.5 mm for all sizes and materials       | PAM-GUD-203 p24         |
| Minimum cover                        | 1.3 m to the crown of the pipe           | PAM-GUD-203 p33         |
| Minimum cover with protection        | 0.5 m                                    | PAM-GUD-203 p33         |
| Recommended maximum cover            | approximately 10 to 12 m                 | PAM-GUD-203 p33         |
| Minimum diameter, laterals and mains | 200 mm outside diameter                  | PAM-GUD-203 Table 6     |
| Maximum lateral length               | 45 m                                     | PAM-GUD-203 Table 6     |
| Manhole spacing, 200 to 315 mm       | 100 m                                    | PAM-GUD-203 Table 12    |
| Manhole spacing, 350 to 900 mm       | 120 m                                    | PAM-GUD-203 Table 12    |
| Backdrop required                    | where inverts differ by more than 600 mm | PAM-GUD-203 p30         |
| Inlet angle at a manhole             | not less than 90 degrees to the flow     | PAM-GUD-203 p19 and p30 |

### 12.1 Hydraulic formulation

Full-bore velocity is computed by the Colebrook-White equation.

$$V = -2\sqrt{2gDS} \log_{10} \left[ \frac{k_s}{3.7D} + \frac{2.51\nu}{D\sqrt{2gDS}} \right] \quad (1)$$

| Symbol         | Meaning                           | Unit              |
|----------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------|
| V              | full-bore velocity                | m/s               |
| g              | acceleration due to gravity       | m/s <sup>2</sup>  |
| D              | internal diameter of the pipe     | m                 |
| S              | hydraulic gradient                | m/m               |
| k <sub>s</sub> | roughness coefficient, 1.5 mm     | m                 |
| ν              | kinematic viscosity of the sewage | m <sup>2</sup> /s |

Gradients are set so that the self-cleansing velocity is achieved at peak flow, and are checked against the minimum gradients tabulated in the guideline. The tabulated gradients correspond to a full-bore velocity of 0.75 m/s; the velocity at the design depth of flow is verified separately for each run.<sup>18</sup>

### 12.2 Sediment transport

Two checks are applied together, and the steeper gradient resulting from them governs: the self-cleansing velocity above, and the minimum tractive force. At the head of the system, where the self-cleansing velocity cannot be achieved, the gradient is set by the tractive force method.

$$S_{\min} = K\tau^{1.23}Q^{-0.461} \quad (2)$$

<sup>18</sup> PAM-GUD-203, Table 11, page 29. The tabulated values have been reproduced using the Colebrook-White equation with a roughness of 1.5 mm at 15 degrees Celsius, and correspond to full-bore flow.

| Symbol | Meaning                                                       | Unit                                           |
|--------|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| S min  | minimum gradient to move the deposited particle               | m/m                                            |
| $\tau$ | tractive tension                                              | Pa                                             |
| Q      | flow                                                          | m <sup>3</sup> /s or l/s, with K taken to suit |
| K      | coefficient, $2.33 \times 10^{-4}$ for Q in m <sup>3</sup> /s | —                                              |

The value of tractive tension to be adopted is not stated in the guidelines. A value will be proposed with its basis and confirmation requested before the gradients are fixed.<sup>19</sup>

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<sup>19</sup> The equation and its coefficient are given at PAM-GUD-203, page 27. No corresponding value of tractive tension in pascals is stated in PAM-GUD-203 or PAM-GUD-201.



## 13 Design criteria: treatment plant

**Table 11** Treatment plant design criteria

| Criterion                      | Value                                                  | Reference                |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Design horizon                 | not less than 15 years                                 | PAM-GUD-203 p65          |
| Planning life cycle            | 25 years                                               | PAM-GUD-201 p57          |
| Design margin                  | 10 per cent                                            | PAM-GUD-201 p73          |
| Size category                  | large where 20,000 m <sup>3</sup> /d or above          | PAM-GUD-203 p65          |
| Organic load                   | not less than 60 g BOD per person per day              | PAM-GUD-203 p74          |
| Solids load                    | not less than 80 g suspended solids per person per day | PAM-GUD-203 p74          |
| COD to BOD ratio, domestic     | 1.8 to 2.2                                             | PAM-GUD-203 p74          |
| Effluent standard              | Class A of MD 145/1993                                 | PAM-GUD-203 p69          |
| Total nitrogen                 | less than 15 mg/l as N                                 | PAM-GUD-203 p71          |
| Chlorine residual at the plant | 0.3 to 1.0 mg/l at the consumer                        | PAM-GUD-203 p71 and p130 |
| Treated effluent produced      | 95 per cent of the inflow                              | PAM-GUD-201 p73          |
| Sludge produced                | 0.25 kg per cubic metre of inflow, indicative          | PAM-GUD-201 p78          |

The total nitrogen limit is the governing criterion for process selection. Class A of Ministerial Decision 145/1993 does not itself set a total nitrogen limit, and the individual nitrogen limits it does set would together permit a higher concentration than 15 mg/l. Full nitrification and denitrification are therefore required.<sup>20</sup>

<sup>20</sup> Class A permits ammoniacal nitrogen at 5 mg/l, organic nitrogen at 5 mg/l and nitrate at 50 mg/l as NO<sub>3</sub>, equivalent to 11.3 mg/l as N.

## Part D Demand and flows

### 14 Population and land use

#### 14.1 Approach

Population is established by two routes, as the guideline permits. The census route projects the official population series and distributes it to settlements. The plot route multiplies the number of plots by the properties on each and by the occupancy rate, and establishes the population at full development. The two answer different questions: the census route gives the population at a stated year, the plot route the ceiling that the land can hold.

#### 14.2 Properties per plot

The number of properties on each plot has been counted from the electricity accounts rather than assumed. Accounts falling within a plot are attributed to it. Accounts sharing a coordinate are counted individually, as each represents a separate connection.

Table 12 Domestic properties and plots

| Quantity                                          | Value  |
|---------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Domestic accounts, including additional dwellings | 22,588 |
| Domestic accounts falling within a plot           | 16,640 |
| Domestic accounts not falling within any plot     | 5,948  |
| Plots carrying at least one domestic account      | 11,425 |
| Mean domestic properties per plot                 | 1.46   |

Approximately one quarter of domestic accounts do not fall within a mapped plot. This reflects the omissions in the cadastral layer described in Section 7.4. These accounts are held unattributed pending the corrected plot layer and the survey, and the mean above is computed only from accounts that are attributed.<sup>21</sup>

#### 14.3 Occupancy rate

The occupancy rate is derived by dividing the population of each settlement by the domestic properties counted within it. Both quantities are taken over the same ground.

$$OR = \frac{\text{Settlement population}}{\text{Domestic properties}} \quad (3)$$

| Symbol | Meaning        | Unit                 |
|--------|----------------|----------------------|
| OR     | occupancy rate | persons per property |

Table 13 Occupancy rate

| Quantity                                   | Value                            |
|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Settlement population, 2024                | 116,456                          |
| Domestic properties within the settlements | 21,889                           |
| <b>Occupancy rate adopted</b>              | <b>5.32 persons per property</b> |
| Occupancy rate, Ibri settlement            | 6.21 persons per property        |

<sup>21</sup> 5,948 of 22,588 domestic accounts, being 26.3 per cent.

The derivation has been checked for consistency of coverage. The twenty-five settlements contain 63.4 per cent of the wilayat population. At the derived occupancy rate the wilayat as a whole would contain 34,504 domestic properties, of which the dataset holds 65.5 per cent. The two proportions agree within 2.1 percentage points, which confirms that the rate is a property of the data rather than an artefact of partial coverage.<sup>22</sup>

Four settlements return values that are not consistent with the remainder and have been excluded from the derivation pending review of their boundaries against the account positions.

## 14.4 Land use

Land use for each plot is established from the tariff carried by the accounts on it. The categories used are set out in Section 7.3. The dataset records the category of a connection but not its size, so it establishes which plots generate non-domestic demand but not how much each generates. The demand itself is therefore established as described in Section 15.

### Agricultural plots

An agricultural connection supplies an irrigation pump, and the water it lifts does not enter the sewer. Where a dwelling stands on an agricultural plot it carries its own domestic connection and is counted as a dwelling. Of 319 plots carrying an agricultural connection, 172 also carry domestic connections and are counted accordingly.<sup>23</sup>

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<sup>22</sup> Wilayat population 183,564 in 2024, from the National Centre for Statistics and Information as reported in the Inception Report.

<sup>23</sup> Those 172 plots carry 428 domestic connections between them, an average of 2.49 per plot, against 1.46 for plots generally.

## 15 Wastewater generation and design flows

### 15.1 Water demand

Wastewater generation is derived from water demand. Demand comprises five components: domestic, non-domestic, governmental, special consumption, and consumption supplied by tanker.

$$Q_{\text{dom}} = \text{Population} \times \text{LPCD} \quad (4)$$

| Symbol | Meaning                                      | Unit  |
|--------|----------------------------------------------|-------|
| Q dom  | domestic water demand                        | l/d   |
| LPCD   | unit consumption, 164 l/c/d for Adh Dhahirah | l/c/d |

Non-domestic and governmental demand are established as proportions of domestic demand.

$$Q_{\text{ND}} = 0.22Q_{\text{dom}} \quad (5)$$

$$Q_{\text{gov}} = 0.14Q_{\text{dom}} \quad (6)$$

The proportions are the values published for the Governorate of Adh Dhahirah. They represent the non-domestic and governmental volumes recorded in the governorate water balance expressed against domestic consumption. The total they produce is therefore a measured quantity; its distribution across the area is established from the land use in Section 14.4.<sup>24</sup>

### 15.2 Return to the sewer

Not all supplied water reaches the sewer. The proportion that does is applied by category.

$$Q_{\text{ww}} = 0.85Q_{\text{dom+tanker}} + 0.54Q_{\text{ND+gov}} \quad (7)$$

| Symbol       | Meaning                                   | Unit              |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Q ww         | wastewater generated, before infiltration | m <sup>3</sup> /d |
| Q dom+tanker | domestic demand and tanker supply         | m <sup>3</sup> /d |
| Q ND+gov     | non-domestic and governmental demand      | m <sup>3</sup> /d |

Water supplied by tanker returns to the sewer at the same proportion as piped supply and is included accordingly.<sup>25</sup>

### 15.3 Infiltration

For newly constructed networks an allowance of 720 litres per day per kilometre of sewer is included. Infiltration from stormwater is not considered.<sup>26</sup>

### 15.4 Peak flow

For catchments of more than one hundred properties the peak daily flow is established by the Merrimack formula.

$$Q_{\text{pdf}} = 2.65Q_{\text{adf}}^{0.879} \quad (8)$$

| Symbol | Meaning         | Unit |
|--------|-----------------|------|
| Q pdf  | peak daily flow | l/d  |

<sup>24</sup> PAM-GUD-201, Table 11, page 60. The column headings describe the ratios as distributed, being governorate volumes recorded between 2021 and 2023.

<sup>25</sup> PAM-GUD-201, Table 19, page 71, which gives a single discharge ratio for domestic and tanker supply.

<sup>26</sup> PAM-GUD-201, Section 7.4.3, page 72.

| Symbol | Meaning            | Unit |
|--------|--------------------|------|
| Q adf  | average daily flow | MI/d |

Both flows are expressed in megalitres per day. The peaking factor is the ratio of the two.<sup>27</sup>

## 15.5 Projection through the design period

Flows are established at five-year intervals across the design period, as required by the Terms of Reference. The calculation is carried out annually and reported at five-year intervals, so that the early years, in which the connected population is a fraction of the ultimate, are represented. The connection ratio applied in each year is taken from the demand model prepared at inception.

The design horizon to be adopted is the subject of Section 5.1. The flow series will be issued in the next revision once the horizon is confirmed and the survey data is available.

## 16 Trade effluent and industrial contributions

Discharges other than domestic sewage affect both the load on the treatment plant and the treatability of the influent. Where the ratio of chemical to biochemical oxygen demand exceeds the domestic range, a separate treatment line for high-strength wastewater is required if the volumes concerned are significant.

The electricity account dataset identifies 499 connections carrying the Cost Reflective Tariff, which is applied to consumers above a consumption threshold. These are being resolved against the plot layer to establish which represent industrial or other high-strength sources. A register of such sources, with the pre-treatment required, will be presented in the next revision.

Sewage delivered by tanker is materially stronger than sewage arriving through the network and is accounted for separately in the plant load.<sup>28</sup>

<sup>27</sup> PAM-GUD-201, Section 7.4.2, page 71. The guideline states that the formula is to be used for a catchment or sub-catchment having over 100 properties.

<sup>28</sup> PAM-GUD-203, Table 31, page 68, gives tankered sewage at 350 to 1,050 mg/l BOD against 350 to 400 mg/l for network sewage.

## 17 Treated effluent demand and customers

Treated effluent is produced at 95 per cent of the plant inflow. A further ten per cent is lost within the distribution network.

$$Q_{\text{delivered}} = 0.90 \times 0.95 \times Q_{\text{inflow}} \quad (9)$$

| Symbol      | Meaning                                 | Unit              |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Q delivered | treated effluent available to customers | m <sup>3</sup> /d |
| Q inflow    | flow entering the treatment plant       | m <sup>3</sup> /d |

Customers are classified as public or private. Public consumers comprise the landscaping of highways, secondary roads, interchanges and roundabouts, and public parks. Private consumers comprise community parks, golf courses, private gardens, and nurseries and farms.

**Table 14 Treated effluent demand for concept planning**

| Planting    | Summer demand                  | Planting            | Summer demand          |
|-------------|--------------------------------|---------------------|------------------------|
| Shrubs      | 20 to 40 l per plant per day   | Ground cover        | 10 l/m <sup>2</sup> /d |
| Palm trees  | 120 to 165 l per plant per day | Seasonal flowers    | 10 l/m <sup>2</sup> /d |
| Other trees | 40 to 80 l per plant per day   | Grass               | 12 l/m <sup>2</sup> /d |
| Hedges      | 10 l per metre per day         | Roads and junctions | 10 l/m <sup>2</sup> /d |

Demand varies seasonally, at 100 per cent from June to August, 75 per cent in spring and autumn and 50 per cent from December to February. The system is sized for the summer peak. Consumers whose average demand exceeds 500 cubic metres per day are assessed individually.<sup>29</sup>

The identification of customers, their present and potential demand and their development plans is in progress. The register will be presented in the next revision.

<sup>29</sup> PAM-GUD-201, Tables 21 to 23, pages 75 and 76. The rate for roads and junctions applies in the absence of specific vegetation information and is subject to municipality approval.

## Part E The existing system

### 18 Hydraulic assessment of the existing networks

#### 18.1 Purpose

The existing sewer, force main and treated effluent networks are assessed against the flows arising across the design period, to establish which assets have capacity for the future flow, which require upgrading, and where the new works connect to them.

#### 18.2 Approach

The assessment is carried out by hydraulic model. The existing network is verified before it is modelled: the datasets supplied provide geometry but not levels, and the diameter is recorded on part of the network only. The survey now in progress establishes both, and the model will be built on the surveyed data.

Each asset is then classified as having capacity for the design flow, requiring upgrading, or requiring replacement. Where an asset is retained, the point and manner of connection to the new works is designed.

#### 18.3 Model

The wastewater network is modelled in SewerGEMS and the treated effluent network in WaterGEMS. Models are submitted in native editable format with the calculations and assumptions, and are updated following construction.<sup>30</sup>

The model is run for the design year at peak flow, for the ultimate condition, and for the opening years at low flow. The last of these establishes the period during which the network requires assisted cleansing, described in Section 22.4.

*The assessment will be presented in the next revision, following completion of the survey.*

### 19 Rehabilitation and upgrading

Rehabilitation of the existing systems forms part of the concept scope. The extent of it follows from the assessment in Section 18 and from the condition established by survey and closed-circuit television inspection.

Rehabilitation work received to date comprises contractor submissions for completed work orders at Al Sad, Khadil, Yanqul, Dhank and Hay Al Aqabah. These have been reviewed and recorded; they describe work already carried out rather than work required.

*The rehabilitation schedule, with quantities and cost, will be presented in the next revision.*

### 20 Verification of the Regional Master Plan

The Terms of Reference require the Regional Master Plan to be verified. The verification compares the flows established in Part D against those on which the master plan was based, and identifies and explains any difference.

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<sup>30</sup> The software to be used is the subject of Section 5.4.

The asset data supplied includes a treatment plant record shown as a design case with a capacity of 29,038 cubic metres per day, annotated as arising from the Regional Master Plan concept design and not yet approved. That figure is taken as the master plan position for comparison.<sup>31</sup>

The comparison depends on the design horizon, which is the subject of Section 5.1, and on the flow series described in Section 15.5. It will be presented in the next revision.

The data required by Nama Water Services Asset Management Planning for the updating of the master plan will be provided in the format the client specifies.

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<sup>31</sup> STP\_PT\_IBRI.shp, record identifier 10, status Design, source recorded as Asset Planning.



## Part F Options

### 21 Options methodology

#### 21.1 Number and character of the options

Not fewer than three options are developed for each of the sewer network, the treated effluent network and the treatment plant. The guidelines indicate the character the options should take: one advancing environmental sustainability including nature-based solutions, one representing international best practice, and one based on established practice and technology available in the Sultanate.<sup>32</sup>

Each option is developed to equivalent functional requirements with comparable reliability and redundancy, so that the comparison between them is not influenced by differences in scope.

#### 21.2 Basis of comparison

The options are compared on capital and operating cost, life cycle cost, carbon footprint over the project lifetime, resource efficiency, in-country value and the degree to which they employ nature-based solutions. The evaluation period is twenty-five years. The weighting applied to each parameter is set by Nama Water Services.

#### 21.3 Selection

A weighted multi-criteria analysis compares the options against total lifetime cost, sustainability, social development and in-country value, adaptability and resilience, operability, constructability and environmental impact. Sensitivity is tested by varying the weighting between categories, the discount rate and the input design criteria. Where options fall within ten per cent of one another on total lifetime cost, the more sustainable option is adopted.<sup>33</sup>

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<sup>32</sup> PAM-GUD-201, Section 12.1, page 95.

<sup>33</sup> PAM-GUD-201, Sections 12.6 to 12.9, pages 104 to 106.

## 22 Sewer network options

### 22.1 Principles

The network is laid out to convey the flow by gravity wherever that is feasible and cost effective, and to keep pumping to the minimum that the topography requires. The layout follows the road corridors, and the flow is directed towards the existing treatment plant site, which lies at a low elevation relative to the developed areas.

### 22.2 Corridor constraints

Dual carriageways are excluded as sewer corridors, as they cannot be taken out of service for construction or maintenance. Crossings of a dual carriageway are made perpendicular and, where available, through an existing underpass. Wadi crossings are designed to the cover required by the guideline.

### 22.3 Network hierarchy

The network is arranged in three tiers, following the arrangement of the existing network in Ibri: laterals collecting from properties, sub-mains collecting from laterals, and a trunk main conveying the collected flow to the plant. Arranging the network this way limits the number of connections made directly to the trunk main and keeps each tier to a manageable size.

### 22.4 Early-year operation

In the years following commissioning the connected population is a fraction of the design population, and the flow in the network is correspondingly lower. Velocities in that period may fall below the self-cleansing value, and the network requires assisted cleansing until the flow is sufficient to scour the pipes.

The period during which this applies is established for each pipe from the flow series and the connection ratio, and is presented as a schedule of the pipes affected and the years concerned, so that the operating requirement is known before the network is handed over.

*The network options and the cleansing schedule will be presented in the next revision.*

## 23 Pumping and lifting stations

A lifting station is provided where the cost of excavation to maintain gravity flow becomes prohibitive. Each station lifts the flow to a level from which gravity conveyance resumes, discharging through a force main to a receiving manhole or to the treatment plant.

**Table 15 Force main design criteria**

| Criterion                           | Value                             |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Minimum velocity, raw sewage        | 0.75 m/s at minimum flow          |
| Minimum velocity, intermittent flow | 1.0 m/s                           |
| Minimum velocity, vertical mains    | 1.2 m/s                           |
| Maximum velocity                    | 2.5 m/s                           |
| Minimum internal diameter           | 75 mm                             |
| Gradient, rising                    | 1 in 500                          |
| Gradient, falling                   | 1 in 300                          |
| Retention time                      | as short as the alignment permits |

Retention in a force main allows sulphide to form, which is both a corrosion and an odour risk in this climate. Alignments are therefore kept short, discharges are submerged to limit turbulence, and the need for dosing is assessed for each station.<sup>34</sup>

Surge analysis is carried out for each force main in approved software, and the protection required is established from it.

## 24 Treated effluent network options

The treated effluent network conveys the product of the treatment plant to the customers identified in Section 17. The network is sized for the summer peak demand, with storage of not less than twenty-four hours.

Where demand is below the volume produced, provision is made for the disposal of the excess, described in Section 26.

*The network options will be presented in the next revision, following confirmation of the customers and their demand.*

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<sup>34</sup> PAM-GUD-203, Sections 8.2.1 and 11.5.3, pages 50 and 181.

## 25 Treatment plant options

### 25.1 Capacity and phasing

The plant is sized on the flow established in Part D with the ten per cent design margin applied, and is built in phases so that capacity follows demand. The capacity of the first phase, and the years at which subsequent phases are required, follow from the flow series and are presented with it.

### 25.2 Process selection

Process selection is governed by the effluent standard. The total nitrogen limit described in Section 13 requires full nitrification and denitrification, which narrows the technologies that can be considered. Land area, energy consumption, operating complexity and whole life cost distinguish the remaining options.

**Table 16** Indicative land requirement by process

| Process                                             | Area, m <sup>2</sup> per m <sup>3</sup> /d |
|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Membrane bioreactor                                 | 0.45 to 0.9                                |
| Sequencing batch reactor                            | 0.9 to 1.8                                 |
| Moving bed biofilm reactor                          | 0.9 to 1.8                                 |
| Integrated fixed film activated sludge              | 1.2 to 2.5                                 |
| Conventional activated sludge and extended aeration | 1.8 to 3.6                                 |

The areas are indicative and are used for planning. The land required includes the process units, the sludge facilities, the buffer zone and provision for the energy-efficiency measures described in Section 34.<sup>35</sup>

### 25.3 Siting

The site is assessed against the criteria in the wastewater guideline, covering access, physical characteristics, environmental and climatic impact, social impact and cost. Two criteria carry stated requirements: the site is assessed against the twenty-five and one hundred year flood levels, and the plant is to remain operational during floods.

The buffer distance to residential areas for a plant of this size is established from odour dispersion modelling rather than from a fixed figure, and lies between 300 and 1,000 metres measured to the five odour unit contour. The modelling is described in Section 30 and precedes the confirmation of the site.<sup>36</sup>

*The plant options, the site assessment and the phasing will be presented in the next revision.*

## 26 Excess effluent, emergency provisions and tankers

### 26.1 Tanker reception

A proportion of the wastewater arising in the area is collected by tanker and delivered to the treatment plant. Sewage delivered this way is stronger than sewage arriving through the network, and its arrival is concentrated in the working day. A dedicated reception facility is provided, with screening, grease removal, sampling before acceptance and flow equalisation.

<sup>35</sup> PAM-GUD-203, Table 28, page 64.

<sup>36</sup> PAM-GUD-201, Table 8, pages 43 and 44.

## 26.2 Excess treated effluent

Where the effluent produced exceeds the demand, provision is made for its disposal. Discharge to a wadi requires the effluent to meet Class A of Ministerial Decision 145/1993, and where the wadi discharges to the sea the limits for ammonia, nitrogen and phosphorus of Ministerial Decision 159/2005 apply in addition. Any such discharge is subject to the approval of the Environment Authority and the Authority for Public Services Regulation.<sup>37</sup>

## 26.3 Emergency provisions

Provision is made for the diversion of raw sewage in the event that the plant is out of operation, and for emergency storage. Every pumping station is provided with an emergency overflow to prevent flooding of the station or of connected properties; overflows are subject to the approval of the Environment Authority.

# 27 Sludge management strategy

The Oman Sludge Management Plan, as reproduced in the wastewater design guideline, identifies a sludge treatment centre performing composting at Ibri as the solution for the Governorate of Adh Dhahirah. The plant is therefore to be designed to receive and process sludge arising beyond its own catchment, and the land area, buffer distance and vehicle access are established accordingly.<sup>38</sup>

Sludge is to be reused unless no form of reuse is possible, and its quality is to comply with the heavy metal limits of Ministerial Decision 145/1993. Where disposal to landfill is required, the receiving authority sets acceptance criteria including a minimum solids content of eighty per cent. That content is above what mechanical dewatering alone achieves, and drying or composting is therefore required.

Dewatering facilities are provided on site. The strategy, with the quantities arising and the disposal route for each, will be presented in the next revision.

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<sup>37</sup> PAM-GUD-203, Section 10.2.4.3, pages 72 and 73. The substituted limits are materially tighter than Class A for phosphorus and ammoniacal nitrogen.

<sup>38</sup> PAM-GUD-203, Table 67, page 136.

## Part G Assessment and appraisal

### 28 Ground conditions

Geophysical investigation is required for all infrastructure and geotechnical investigation for all above-ground assets. At this stage the purpose is to establish a site-wide ground model and a range of parameters sufficient to select foundation types and platform levels, and to identify the risks that the detailed investigation must resolve.

Boreholes at the treatment plant and lifting station sites are taken to a minimum depth of fifteen metres or to a competent stratum, and are closely spaced at wet wells, valve chambers and electrical rooms. Groundwater monitoring is required, as the depth to groundwater governs both the excavation method and the infiltration allowance.

*The ground model and the concept geotechnical report will be presented in the next revision.*

### 29 Flood protection

The study area is crossed by a wadi system, and flood behaviour governs both the alignment of the works and the siting of the treatment plant. The site is assessed against the twenty-five and one hundred year flood levels, and the plant is to remain operational during floods.

Pumping station floor levels, transformers and standby generators are set not less than 300 millimetres above the one in fifty year flood level. Wadi crossings are designed with a minimum cover of 1.5 metres to the crown of the pipe.

*The flood protection assessment will be presented in the next revision.*

### 30 Odour assessment

Odour governs the buffer distance between the treatment plant and residential development, and for a plant of this size the buffer is established from dispersion modelling rather than from a fixed distance. The modelling establishes the distance to the five odour unit contour, using site meteorological records and the treatment processes proposed.<sup>39</sup>

Odour control is provided at the inlet works, the sludge facilities and the pumping stations, with the treatment train selected from the assessment. Compliance is verified by continuous monitoring at the site boundary.

*The dispersion modelling and the resulting buffer will be presented in the next revision, and precede confirmation of the plant site.*

### 31 Climate resilience

The works are assessed for resilience to the climate conditions anticipated over their service life. The assessment considers a fifty-year horizon at two and at four degrees Celsius of warming, and addresses the effect of changes in rainfall frequency and intensity on site selection and on the design of the infrastructure.<sup>40</sup>

*The assessment will be presented in the next revision.*

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<sup>39</sup> PAM-GUD-201, Table 8, page 43; PAM-GUD-203, Table 90, page 170, which sets five odour units per cubic metre at the site boundary where the surrounding area is sensitive.

<sup>40</sup> PAM-GUD-201, Section 4.3, page 33.

## 32 Environmental and social assessment

An environmental impact assessment is required for the treatment plant and its associated works. The Environment Authority is informed of the project, its objectives and its anticipated impact, and is consulted on the location of the facilities.

Each option is assessed against resource use, ecosystem disruption, pollution risk, climate resilience, socio-economic impact and land use, and the assessment forms part of the comparison described in Section 38.

The scope required at this stage is the subject of Section 5.5.

## 33 Utility interfaces and approvals

### 33.1 Approach

The proposed alignments are superimposed on the service records of each authority holding assets in the area. Where a conflict cannot be avoided by re-routing within the corridor, the cost of relocating the proposed works is compared with the cost of relocating the existing service, and the agreement of the owning authority is obtained for whichever is adopted.

### 33.2 Records held and required

The potable water network is available from the dataset described in Section 7.2 and provides 647.8 kilometres of mains within the study area. Records for electricity distribution, telecommunications and, where present, gas and fuel pipelines are being requested from the respective owners.

The electricity data held records the position of consumer connections. It does not record the routes of the distribution cables, which are required for clash assessment and are requested separately.<sup>41</sup>

### 33.3 Clearances

Table 17 Separation from other services

| Situation                            | Requirement                                                   |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Force main to water main, horizontal | 3.0 m                                                         |
| Force main crossing a water main     | the force main passes beneath, with 450 mm vertical clearance |
| Shallow sewer beneath a major road   | 3.0 m horizontal clearance                                    |
| Another service in the same trench   | placed on a separate bench on undisturbed ground              |

Beyond these, the clearance applied is that specified by the authority owning the service.

### 33.4 Trial pits

Fifty trial pits are provided for. Their locations are selected at road intersections, along the routes of major existing services and along the expected routes of the trunk sewers and force mains. The programme is agreed with Nama Water Services and the municipal excavation approvals obtained before work begins.

### 33.5 Approvals register

Approvals and no objection certificates are required from the authorities listed below. A register is maintained recording the authority, the consent required, the date of application and the current position, and is reported to Nama Water Services.

| Authority                                              |
|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Ministry of Housing and Urban Planning                 |
| Environment Authority                                  |
| Ministry of Agriculture, Fisheries and Water Resources |
| Directorate General of Roads                           |
| Regional electricity distribution company              |
| Oman Telecommunications Company                        |
| Royal Oman Police                                      |

<sup>41</sup> The account dataset described in Section 7.3 comprises point locations of metered connections.



| Authority                        |
|----------------------------------|
| Ministry of Heritage and Tourism |
| Municipality of Ibri             |

## 34 Sustainability

The carbon footprint of each option is evaluated for both construction and operation in accordance with recognised greenhouse gas accounting standards, and is expressed in tonnes of carbon dioxide equivalent per year and per cubic metre of effluent produced.<sup>42</sup>

Because the greater part of operational emissions arises from electricity consumption, the measures that reduce carbon are largely the same as those that reduce operating cost: conveying the flow by gravity wherever possible, minimising lift, selecting efficient equipment, and generating renewable energy on site. Provision for photovoltaic generation within the plant perimeter is included in the land requirement.

Resource efficiency, in-country value and the use of nature-based solutions are assessed for each option and carried into the comparison in Section 38.

## 35 Cost

### 35.1 Basis

| Item         | Basis                                                           |
|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Accuracy     | plus or minus twenty per cent at concept stage                  |
| Measurement  | CESMM3                                                          |
| Rates        | current market rates, from recent tender and contract documents |
| Price basis  | current prices at the date of the estimate                      |
| Presentation | by system element                                               |

### 35.2 Scope of the estimate

The estimate covers the works, the associated costs and the provisions, as set out below.

- **Collection network** — excavation by depth and by ground condition, trench support, bedding and backfill, pipework, manholes, property connections, road reinstatement, traffic management, crossings, and testing.
- **Lifting stations** — land, civil structures, pumps and station pipework, electrical supply and standby generation, control and telemetry, odour control, and the force main with its chambers and valves.
- **Treatment plant** — land, site preparation and flood protection, inlet works, tanker reception, biological treatment, clarification, tertiary treatment, disinfection, the sludge line, chemical systems, odour control, electrical and control installations, buildings, and commissioning.
- **Treated effluent network** — pipework, storage, boosting, filling stations and customer connections.
- **Associated costs** — design and supervision, survey and investigation, environmental assessment, consents and land, and physical and price contingency.

*The estimate will be presented with the options in the next revision.*

## 36 Risk

A risk register is established at this stage and maintained through the project. Each risk carries a description, a likelihood, an impact expressed in cost or time, an owner and the mitigation adopted. Risks that fall on one option and not on another are identified as such, as they affect the comparison rather than only the total.

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<sup>42</sup> PAM-GUD-201, Section 12.5.1, pages 98 to 100, which cites ISO 14064 and the Greenhouse Gas Protocol and gives a benchmark of  $1.17 \times 10^{-3}$  tonnes of carbon dioxide equivalent per cubic metre of treated effluent.

### 37 Value engineering

A formal value engineering study is required at the concept and preliminary stages for a treatment plant or pumping station above the stated threshold, carried out by an independent certified consultant. The study is arranged within the concept programme and its outcome reported.<sup>43</sup>

### 38 Comparison and recommendation

The options are compared by the method described in Section 21.3. The comparison presents, for each option, the capital cost by phase, the operating cost by year, the net present value over twenty-five years, the carbon footprint, and the assessment against each of the remaining criteria, together with the results of the sensitivity tests.

$$NPV = \sum_{t=0}^n \frac{C_t}{(1+i)^t}$$

(10)

| Symbol | Meaning            | Value      |
|--------|--------------------|------------|
| C t    | net cost in year t | —          |
| i      | discount rate      | 5 per cent |
| n      | evaluation period  | 25 years   |

*The comparison and the recommended option will be presented in the next revision.*

<sup>43</sup> PAM-GUD-201, Table 27, page 93, and its accompanying note.

## Part H Delivery

### 39 Implementation roadmap

An implementation roadmap is prepared for the recommended option, defining the scope of the subsequent design stages, the procurement route for each element, the phasing of construction, and the framework by which performance is monitored once the works are in service.

*The roadmap follows the selection of the recommended option and will be presented with it.*

### 40 Contracting strategy

The contracting strategy establishes how the works are packaged and procured. It is developed with Nama Water Services in a dedicated workshop, and considers the division of the works into packages, the procurement route for each, and the interfaces between them.

### 41 Project integration

A project integration plan sets out how the water and wastewater components are coordinated through design, construction and commissioning. It also addresses the rehabilitation or replacement of the existing potable water network where its performance is found to be unsatisfactory.<sup>44</sup>

### 42 Conclusions

The design basis for the wastewater and treated effluent systems is established and is set out in Part C. The data supplied has been assessed, and the datasets that are usable, those that require correction and those that relate to areas outside the project have been identified in Part B.

The existing wastewater assets within the study area comprise 310.9 kilometres of gravity sewer, 33.2 kilometres of force main and 45.7 kilometres of treated effluent main. The potable water network within the area comprises 647.8 kilometres of mains. The number of properties on each plot and the category of use have been established from 33,970 electricity accounts, and an occupancy rate of 5.32 persons per property has been derived and checked.

A topographic and utility survey covering the whole study area is in progress. It will establish the levels, diameters and condition that the supplied datasets do not carry, and its completion is the principal step between this revision and the next.

#### 42.1 Recommendations

It is recommended that Nama Water Services confirm the six matters set out in Section 5, and that the datasets identified in Section 7 as requiring correction or clarification be resolved, so that the flow series, the options and the appraisal can be completed on an agreed basis.

### 43 Appendices

| Appendix | Content                   |
|----------|---------------------------|
| A        | Data register and sources |

<sup>44</sup> PAM-GUD-201, Section 13, page 107.

| Appendix | Content                                    |
|----------|--------------------------------------------|
| B        | Design criteria, with references           |
| C        | Population and demand calculations         |
| D        | Drawings and figures                       |
| E        | Register of matters requiring confirmation |

*The appendices will be issued with the next revision.*